

Patient Admission Guidelines

Admissions Department

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Department: Admissions Department

Status: Active

1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines the standard procedure for admitting patients into Shifa Hospital, covering both planned (elective) and emergency admissions across all inpatient departments.

2. Types of Admission

2.1 Elective Admission

Scheduled in advance by a consultant for planned procedures, surgeries, or investigations. Requires a valid admission slip signed by the treating consultant.

2.2 Emergency Admission

Initiated directly from the Emergency Department when a patient requires immediate inpatient care. Bed allocation is prioritized based on clinical severity.

2.3 Transfer Admission

Patients transferred from another facility or department (e.g., ICU to ward) following physician clearance and bed availability confirmation.

3. Eligibility & Required Documents

- Valid CNIC / B-Form (for minors) or passport for foreign nationals
- Admission slip / referral note signed by the consultant
- Insurance card or panel letter, if applicable
- Previous medical records, if the patient is a returning patient
- Guarantor / next of kin contact details

4. Admission Process

- Step 1: Patient or attendant reports to the Admissions desk with required documents
- Step 2: Front desk verifies documents and generates a Medical Record (MR) number if new
- Step 3: Bed allocation is confirmed with the relevant ward based on availability
- Step 4: Financial counseling is completed — advance payment, insurance approval, or panel verification
- Step 5: Patient is escorted to the ward and handed over to the nursing staff with the admission file
- Step 6: Admitting nurse completes the initial nursing assessment within one hour of ward arrival

5. Bed Allocation Policy

Beds are allocated on a first-come, first-served basis within each clinical priority tier. Emergency and critical-care admissions take precedence over elective admissions. If no bed is available, the patient is placed on the ward waiting list and notified of the estimated wait time.

6. Payment & Insurance

Self-paying patients are required to submit an advance deposit prior to ward transfer, except in emergency life-threatening situations where treatment is never delayed for payment. Insured patients must present a valid panel letter; the Admissions desk coordinates pre-authorization with the insurance/TPA provider.

7. Patient Rights During Admission

- Right to be informed of diagnosis, treatment plan, and estimated cost
- Right to request a second opinion
- Right to privacy and confidentiality of medical records
- Right to refuse treatment after being informed of the consequences

8. Discharge Planning Overview

Discharge planning begins at the time of admission. The attending consultant, in coordination with nursing and the admissions/billing office, ensures a discharge summary, medication reconciliation, and follow-up appointment are prepared before the patient leaves the ward.